

PRAGYA ARYAL

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WORK EXPERIENCE

GOVERNANCE LAB

Nepal

Facilitator

July 2026 – Present

- Facilitate local women leaders' network meetings in Dhulikhel Municipality, Kavrepalanchowk, and Bhimeshwar Municipality, Dolakha
- Coordinate meeting logistics, track attendance, take notes, and create an environment where local leaders can exchange advice, discuss challenges, and develop solutions while supporting one another
- Support a Randomized Controlled Trial (RCT) through field facilitation and network-building to increase women's participation as candidates for Mayor, Deputy Mayor, and Ward Chair in upcoming local elections

NEW YORK CITY DEPARTMENT OF TRANSPORTATION (NYC DOT)

New York City, USA

CityGAP Fellow

Feb 2026 – May 2026

- Serve as point person with the NYC DOT Urban Design Team to gamify the Street Design Manual in collaboration with the Living City Project
- Coordinate and lead meetings with inter-agency departments and stakeholders to understand Street Design Manual usage
- Manage and guide Living City Project gap year students through the game development process as Project Manager

SUMANA SHRESTHA SECRETARIAT

Kathmandu, Nepal

Digital Communication Fellow

Jan 2023 – Aug 2025

- Created and managed digital branding and content, growing TikTok and Instagram to 100K+ organic followers in 2 years
- Translated complex political concepts into accessible content, engaging primarily youth audiences (80% under 30)
- Researched political trends and patterns to inform communication strategy and content development

AFRISTEM

Capetown, South Africa

Apprentice | Curriculum Developer lead

Sept 2023 - Dec 2023

- Led the project of designing a comprehensive 12-hour web development module and its teaching manual, aimed at assisting high school and college graduates in securing jobs in frontend development
- Created a beginner-friendly Scratch coding e-book tailored for middle school students in low-income areas
- Designed the organization's logo, email signature, and letterhead; Initiated and managed social media platforms, gaining 80+ followers and over 300% engagement in a month.

VOLUNTEER

SHETHEKRANTI

Nepal

Core Team | Website Developer

Apr 2023 – Jun 2025

- Developed, designed and hosted the official website
- Generating content to raise awareness on topics like HIV/AIDS, PCOs, and Queer issues through digital platforms
- Conducted workshops on sustainable pad-making, sexual health education, harassment, bullying, and mental health in schools and Aama Samuha in different regions of Nepal
- Actively engaged with the team to plan and execute workshops and events that align with organization's goals of creating safe and brave spaces to bring together queer individuals and women to share, listen, and build camaraderie

YUWA NEPAL

Nepal

General Member | Former CURIEA Political Cohort

Aug 2024 – Present

- Participated in political education sessions and thematic discussions on Nepal's political system and governance
- Engaged in civic awareness initiatives, helping demystify political misconceptions and encourage informed discussions within communities
- Volunteered at organizational events and programs, supporting outreach and community engagement activities
- Contributed to digital campaigns and youth-led initiatives promoting civic participation, democratic values, and political literacy

RESEARCH & DEVELOPMENT EXPERIENCE

Under the banner of New York City Subway

- Developed a multimedia storytelling project examining the New York City subway as a shared public space through personal experiences, essays, and visual narratives.
- Built an interactive website encouraging visitors to contribute their own stories and perspectives, fostering community engagement.

COMPARATIVE POLICY & GOVERNANCE ANALYSIS OF PUBLIC SPACE IN KATHMANDU AND NYC

- Conducted qualitative research on public space governance and policy in Kathmandu and New York through literature review, stakeholder interviews, and field observation
- Applied comparative analysis to identify gaps in accessibility, inclusion, and local public space management
- Produced policy recommendations and academic writing to create and sustain more local and inclusive public spaces in Kathmandu

GENDER-SENSITIVE HATE SPEECH DETECTION IN NEPALI POLITICS

- Designed and led an independent research project on gender-sensitive online hate speech in Nepali political discourse
- Conducted a literature review of prior research on hate speech detection in the Nepali language, including political discourse, online abuse, and gendered language in Nepal
- Developed a machine learning/NLP-based model to detect gender-sensitive hate speech in Nepali political content

WEBSITE FOR A FEMINIST CAMPAIGN

- Designed and developed the website using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript to improve digital accessibility and user experience
- Collaborated with stakeholders to translate organizational needs into a responsive design and managed content structure to enhance engagement

EDUCATION

LIVING CITY PROJECT

New York City as Classroom

Public Policy, Urban Planning, History, Community Centered Projects

New York City, USA

Sept 2025 - May 2026

HERALD COLLEGE KATHMANDU

BSC Computer Science (Hons)

Relevant Coursework: Project & Professionalism; Collaborative Development; Big Data; AI & ML

Kathmandu, Nepal

Nov 2022 - July 2025

BUDHANILKANTHA SCHOOL

High School (Science)

Kathmandu, Nepal

2019 - 2021

SKILLS

Languages: Working proficiency in English, Nepali, and Hindi

Technical Skills: Canva, Figma, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, SQL, Python

Additional Skills: Research, storytelling, digital communication & branding, data analysis, and website development

CERTIFICATIONS

CityGAP Student, *The Living City Project, New York City, USA* — Sept 2025 - May 2026

Emergent Future Fellowship, *Initiatives Of Change, Panchgani, Pune India* — January 20-27, 2025

Seeking Authenticity through Challenging Mis/Disinformation Bootcamp, *Youth Innovation Lab, Nepal* — February 25-28, 2025

Young Politicians Camp, *Center for Political Leadership, Nepal* — March 7-9, 2025

Representative Youth Consultation for Informed Advocacy, *Yuwa Nepal* — 2024

Take Action Lab, *Tilting Futures, Capetown, South Africa* — Aug-Dec, 2023